

TOPIC 8: JESUS' UNDERSTANDING OF FAMILY & THE BAPTISM OF JESUS

1. Jesus' Understanding of Family (Matthew 12:46–50; Mark 3:31–35)

When Jesus' mother and brothers came seeking Him, He pointed to His disciples and said that whoever does the will of God is His brother, sister and mother. He did not reject His earthly family, but taught that spiritual relationship with God creates a wider family of faith that transcends blood ties.

2. John the Baptist as Forerunner (Mark 1:1–8; Luke 3:1–20)

John the Baptist prepared the way for Jesus. He preached a baptism of repentance for the forgiveness of sins, called people to bear fruit in keeping with repentance, and pointed to the One who would baptise with the Holy Spirit. He was the voice crying in the wilderness (Isaiah 40:3).

3. The Baptism of Jesus (Matthew 3:13–17)

Jesus came to John to be baptised. John hesitated, but Jesus insisted that it was necessary to fulfil all righteousness. When Jesus was baptised, the heavens opened, the Spirit of God descended like a dove, and a voice from heaven said, "This is my beloved Son, with whom I am well pleased."

4. Significance of Jesus' Baptism

- Identification with sinful humanity (though He was sinless).
- Public affirmation of His identity as the Son of God.
- Empowerment by the Holy Spirit for ministry.
- Model of obedience and the beginning of His public ministry.

5. Summary

Jesus taught that doing God's will makes us part of God's family. His baptism by John marked the start of His public ministry and revealed Him as the beloved Son, empowered by the Spirit.

End of Topic 8 – Jesus' Family Understanding & Baptism

— End of JSS 2 Christian Religious Studies First Term Notes —